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Wastewater filtering method and apparatus comprising filter media of different sizes

Abstract

Disclosed are a wastewater filtering method and apparatus comprising filter media of different sizes. According to one aspect of the present embodiment, provided a wastewater filtering method and apparatus capable of stable and efficient operation by minimizing the head loss as well as simultaneously removing organic matter and solids in a large flow of wastewater.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present invention relates to a filtration device and method by using different size media for stably and effectively removing contaminants from wastewater.

BACKGROUND ART

(2) The content described in this section merely provides background information on an embodiment of the present invention and does not constitute the prior art.

(3) In recent years, the frequency and intensity of rainfall have been changed due to climate change caused by global warming. It is necessary to treat properly the initial stormwater generated during rainfall because the pollution load caused by rainfall continuously increases. The initial stormwater has a high flow rate, but relatively low pollutants compared to sewage, and the concentration of pollutants changes over time. The research results shows that the flow rate is low, but the concentrations of total biochemical oxygen demand (TBOD) and total suspended solid (TSS) are high at the beginning of the rainfall, but the concentration of BOD and TSS decreases as the flow

rate increases due to the dilution effect. It is known that the initial stormwater is irregular and intermittent, but it is a cause of deterioration of the water quality of the discharged water body because the accumulated pollutants in sewer line are discharged at once.

(4) Settling and filtration processes are used to treat stormwater. It is known that the settling process can remove quickly suspended solid matter (SS) by increasing the settling velocity with adding coagulant and flocculant. However, it is known that the flow rate and water quality of the initial stormwater change rapidly with time, so it is challenging to maintain proper coagulation conditions in the actual field. The filtration process can effectively remove solids even when the flow rate fluctuates widely. However, it has a disadvantage because the backwash cycle to remove the solids trapped in the media increases when the solids load increases. In particular, the filtration technology using a single filter medium has a limitation because the filtration duration is shortened because solids are stocked at the filter media located on the inlet side.

(5) Settling and filtration processes are physical treatment processes that can effectively remove solids, but it is difficult to remove dissolved pollutants from wastewater, such as SBOD (soluble BOD).

(6) Therefore, an alternative is a biological aerated filter (BAF) process to economically and efficiently remove not only solids but also dissolved organic matter such as SBOD from the stormwater.

(7) Conventional biofiltration processes have filtered stormwater using packed media (sunken media). The biofiltration process using sunken media can flow up and down. In the biological filtration process using sunken media, backwashing is performed by supplying backwash water and backwashing air. However, additional energy is consumed since a large-capacity backwash water supply pump is required to expand the filter medium. Since the solids trapped at the bottom must also be removed to the top through the expansion of the filter media in the upward flow, it has a disadvantage that a separate pretreatment process is essential to remove the solids in the influent when the influent suspended solids concentration is high.

DISCLOSURE

Technical Problem

(8) An embodiment of the present invention has an object to provide a wastewater filtration device and method capable of stable and efficient operation by minimizing the head loss while simultaneously removing organics and solids in high-flow wastewater.

Technical Solution

(9) According to one aspect of the present invention, the present invention provides a filtration device for treating wastewater, the device comprising: a distribution channel for distributing an incoming wastewater vertically upward or discharging backwash water, received vertically downward, to the outside; filter media for raising due to a lower specific gravity than water when the wastewater is distributed vertically upward from the distribution channel to filter solids and organics in the wastewater and descending when the backwash water flows in vertically downward to remove the attached solids and organics; and a treated water storage tank for receiving the treated water from which solids and organics are removed through the filter media and discharging it to the outside or discharging the backwash water flowing in from the outside to the filter media.

(10) According to one aspect of the present invention, the filtration device is characterized by further comprising a nozzle for being disposed at one end of the treated water storage tank, having a plurality of outlets smaller than the filter media, and receiving or discharging wastewater or backwash water.

(11) According to one aspect of the present invention, the filter media is characterized by comprising at least two types of filter media having different sizes.

(12) According to one aspect of the present invention, it is characterized in that the filter media having a relatively larger size receive a greater buoyancy than the filter media having a relatively smaller size by the wastewater distributed vertically upward by the distribution channel.

(13) According to one aspect of the present invention, the present invention provides a filtration method of wastewater by a wastewater filtration device, the method being characterized by comprising: a distribution process for distributing the incoming wastewater vertically upward; a first filtration process for filtering solids in the distributed wastewater; a second filtration process for filtering fine solids and organics from wastewater from which solids are filtered; a discharge process for storing each component-filtered treated water or discharging it to the outside; and a spraying process for spraying backwash water vertically downward.

(14) According to one aspect of the present invention, it is characterized in that the first filtration process and the second filtration process are carried out by filter media.

(15) According to one aspect of the present invention, the filter media is characterized by comprising at least two types of filter media having different sizes.

(16) According to one aspect of the present invention, it is characterized in that the filter media having a relatively larger size receive a greater buoyancy than the filter media having a relatively smaller size by the wastewater distributed vertically upward by the distribution channel, thereby performing the first filtration process with the filter media having a relatively smaller size and performing the second filtration process with the filter media having a relatively larger size.

Advantageous Effects

(17) As described above, according to one aspect of the present invention, there is an advantage to allow stable and efficient operation by minimizing the head loss while simultaneously removing organics and solids from high flow wastewater.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view illustrating a wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(2) FIG. 2 is a cross-sectional view illustrating a wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(3) FIG. 3 is a view showing filter media according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(4) FIG. 4 is a schematic view illustrating a state in which wastewater are introduced into the wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(5) FIG. 5 is a schematic view illustrating a state in which backwash water is introduced into the wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(6) FIG. 6 is a graph illustrating the solids removal rate of the wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(7) FIG. 7 is a graph illustrating the TBOD removal rate of the wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(8) FIG. 8 is a graph illustrating the SBOD removal rate the wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(9) FIG. 9 is a flowchart illustrating a filtration method of the wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(10) FIG. 10 is a cross-sectional view and a bottom view illustrating a strainer block and a nozzle according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(11) FIG. 11 is a cross-sectional view illustrating a strainer block according to various embodiments of the present invention.

(12) FIG. 12 is a plan view illustrating the diffuser according to the first embodiment of the present invention.

(13) FIG. 13 is a plan view illustrating a diffuser according to a second embodiment of the present invention.

(14) FIG. 14 is a cross-sectional view illustrating a main or branch pipe according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(15) FIG. 15 is a view illustrating a drag force applied to a conventional diffuser and a diffuser according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(16) FIG. 16 is a view illustrating the size of a conventional diffuser and a diffuser according to an embodiment of the present invention.

MODE FOR INVENTION

(17) Various modifications may be made to the present invention, and the present invention may have various embodiments. Specific embodiments are illustrated in the drawings and described in detail. However, it should be understood that this is not intended to limit the present invention to specific embodiments, and all modifications, equivalents and substitutes included in the spirit and scope of the present invention are included. In describing each figure, like reference numerals have been used for like elements.

(18) Terms such as first, second, A, and B may be used to describe various elements, but the elements should not be limited by the terms. The above terms are used only for the purpose of distinguishing one element from another. For example, without departing from the scope of the present invention, a first component may be referred to as a second component, and similarly, a second component may also be referred to as a first component. Term “and/or” includes a combination of a plurality of related listed items or any of a plurality of related listed items.

(19) When a component is referred to as being “coupled” or “connected” to another component, it is understood that the component may be directly coupled or connected to another component, but other components may exist in therebetween. On the other hand, when it is said that a component is “directly coupled” or “directly connected” to another component, it should be understood that no other component is present in the middle.

(20) The terms used in the present application are only used to describe specific embodiments and are not intended to limit the present invention. The singular expression includes the plural expression unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. It should be understood that terms such as “comprise” or “have” in the present application do not preclude the possibility of addition or existence of features, numbers, steps, operations, components, parts, or combinations thereof described in the specification in advance.

(21) Unless defined otherwise, all terms used herein, including technical and scientific terms, have the same meaning as commonly understood by one of ordinary skill in the art to which this invention belongs.

(22) Terms such as those defined in a commonly used dictionary should be interpreted as having a meaning consistent with the meaning in the context of the related art and should not be interpreted in an ideal or excessively formal meaning unless explicitly defined in the present application.

(23) Further, each configuration, step, process or method included in each embodiment of the present invention may be shared within a range that does not technically contradict each other.

(24) FIG. 1 is a perspective view illustrating wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 2 is a cross-sectional view illustrating a wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 3 is a view showing filter media according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(25) Referring to FIG. 1 and FIG. 2, the wastewater filtration device **100**, in an embodiment of the present invention, comprises an inflow water tank **110**, a distribution channel **120**, filter media **134** and **138**, diffusers **140a** and **140b**, a treated water storage tank **150**, a strainer block **210**, a nozzle **220** and a controller (not shown).

(26) The filtration device **100** performs an up-flow biological filtration process, including flotation filter media. The wastewater filtration device **100** performs both physical filtration by the flotation filter media and biological treatment by microorganisms proliferated in the flotation filter media layer.

(27) The inflow water box **110** receives to-be-treated wastewater from the outside. The inflow water box **110** receives wastewater from the outside and delivers the wastewater introduced through the inflow pipe **118** to the distribution channel **120**. One or more inflow water channels may be provided according to the throughput.

(28) The distribution channel **120** distributes the wastewater flowing through the inlet water box **110** vertically upward or receives backwash water vertically downward and discharges it outside.

(29) Wastewater passing through the inflow pipe **118** is introduced into the distribution channel **120**. The distribution channel **120** receives and distributes the wastewater vertically upward (the direction in which the filter media **134** and **138** exist). The distribution channel **120** may unevenly spray the wastewater vertically upward, but in order to improve the filtration efficiency, the wastewater is evenly distributed and discharged vertically. When receiving wastewater and trying to distribute it vertically upward, the distribution water channel **120** opens the inflow valve **129** to allow wastewater to flow in and closes the discharge valve to prevent the inflowed wastewater from being discharged to the outside.

(30) Conversely, the distribution water channel **120** receives the backwash water vertically downward and discharges it to the outside. When the wastewater filtration has been performed for a certain period, cleaning of the filter media **134** and **138** should be performed. Such backwashing proceeds as the backwash water is discharged from the treated water storage tank **150** to the filter media **134** and **138** through the nozzle **220**. The distribution water channel **120** closes the inflow valve **129** and opens the discharge valve **126** so that the introduced backwash water is discharged to the outside.

(31) The filter media **134** and **138** physically remove solids from the incoming wastewater and, at the same time, biologically remove organics as well.

(32) The filter media **134** and **138** have a smaller specific gravity than water and ascend together with the wastewater when the wastewater inflows. The filter media **134** and **138** ascend together to the height at which the strainer block **210** is located and cannot ascend further by the strainer block **210**, and layers separate according to their size and begin to clump together. The clumped media **134** and **138** remove solids or organics depending on the size. Meanwhile, when the backwash water is discharged from the treated water storage tank **150** and inflows into the reaction tank **130** for backwashing the filter media **134** and **138**, the filter media **134** and **138** are cleaned by washing out substances accumulated during filtration according to their size.

(33) The wastewater filtration device **100** includes at least two types of filter media **134** and **138** having different sizes (volumes). When the wastewater distributed from the distribution channel **120** flows into the reaction tank **130**, the wastewater is distributed vertically upward, so each filter medium is buoyant in the wastewater. At this time, the filter media having different sizes receive different buoyancy forces by the wastewater, as shown in the following formula.

$$B = \rho V g$$

(34) Here, B represents the buoyancy force, ρ represents the density of the fluid, V represents the volume of an object submerged in the fluid, and g represents the acceleration due to gravity. At this time, the density and gravitational acceleration of the fluid is constant, so the factor that has a decisive influence on the buoyancy of the filter media is the particle volume. Accordingly, as the volume of the particles increases, they are more affected by the buoyancy force to be arranged relatively densely at the top.

(35) Conversely, when the backwash water inflows into the reaction tank **130**, the small-sized filter media have a relatively large volume expansion rate by the backwash water because the upward velocity due to the buoyancy is small. On the other hand, the large-sized filter media have a relatively small volume expansion rate by backwash water because the upward velocity due to buoyancy is large.

(36) According to the above description, although filter media having different sizes are randomly arranged in the reaction tank **130**, the layers in which the filter media are present are naturally

classified according to their size by the inflow of wastewater or backwash water. Further, although the wastewater and the backwash water are introduced in different directions, the phenomenon in which the layers of the filter media are reversed does not occur due to the above-described reason.

(37) As shown in FIG. 3A, the amount of buoyancy acting as the filter media **134** is relatively small, and the filter media **134** having a relatively small size, is disposed at the (relatively) lower end of the reaction tank **130**. The diameter of the filter media **134** may be 3.0 mm to 8.0 mm, and the filter media **134** may be disposed at the height of 0.5 to 2.0 m. As such, the filter media **134** having a relatively small diameter makes fine pores to remove solids in the wastewater. Meanwhile, when the backwash water flows into the filter media **134**, the filter media **134** exhibits a relatively large volume expansion rate due to a relatively small amount of buoyancy. For example, the filter media **134** may expand by 50% to 100% of the volume when the backwash water is introduced compared to the volume when the wastewater is introduced. When the backwash water is introduced, the filter media **134** expand relatively much in volume, so the solids filtered by the filter media are efficiently detached and discharged together with the backwash water.

(38) Meanwhile, as shown in FIG. 3B, the amount of buoyancy acting as the filter media **138** is relatively large, and the filter media **138** having a relatively large size, is disposed at the (relatively) upper end of the reaction tank **130**. The diameter of the filter media **138** may be 4.0 mm to 10.0 mm, and the filter media **138** may be disposed at the height of 2.0 to 3.5 m. Since the filter media **138** have a relatively large size, it has a relatively large number of pores compared to the filter media **134**. Accordingly, aerobic microorganisms for decomposing organics in wastewater are attached to the surface of the filter media **138** to be grown smoothly. The filter media **138** uses aerobic microorganisms grown on its surface to remove relatively small-sized solids and dissolved organics that are not removed even by the filter media **134** from the wastewater. Meanwhile, when the backwash water is introduced, the filter media **138** desorbs the microbial film (formed on the surface) from which the solids and organics are removed using the washing air and the shear force of the wash water. The detached microorganisms are discharged together with the backwash water and washing air.

(39) The diffuser **140a** and **140b** supply washing air for the growth of microorganisms or to clean the filter media **134** and **138**.

(40) The diffuser **140a** is disposed in the reaction tank **130** to supply oxygen to the filter media **138**. The diffuser **140a** may be disposed at a position where the filter media **138** ascends and forms a layer in the reaction tank **130** by the inflow of wastewater and mainly supplies oxygen to the filter media **138**. Alternatively, the diffuser **140a** may be disposed at a position where drag force is applied by wastewater, backwash water, or elevating and descending filter media in the reaction tank **130**. The diffuser **140a** supplies electron acceptors necessary for aerobic microorganisms to oxidize organics. The diffuser **140a** may supply oxygen as an electron acceptor by supplying air but may also supply pure oxygen in some cases. According to the oxygen supply of the diffuser **140a**, the filter media **138** may remove small-sized solids and dissolved organics that the filter media **134** could not remove using aerobic microorganisms.

(41) Meanwhile, the diffuser **140b** is disposed at an arbitrary position in the reaction tank **130** to supply washing air for cleaning the filter media **134** and **138**. The solids or organics growing or adhering to the filter media **134** and **138** may be cleaned by backwash water, but in order to improve cleaning efficiency, the diffuser **140b** may supply washing air together.

(42) A description of the diffuser **140** is provided later with reference to FIG. 12, FIG. 13, FIG. 14, FIG. 15, and FIG. 16.

(43) The treated water storage tank **150** receives the treated water passing through the filter media **134** and **138** and discharges it to the outside or receives the backwash water from the outside and discharges it to the filter media **134** and **138**. The treated water from which contaminants (solids and organics) are filtered by the filter media **134** and **138** is introduced into the treated water storage tank **150** through the nozzle **220** or the strainer block **210** and the nozzle **220**. In order to be

used as backwash water in other wastewater filtration devices, the treated water storage tank **150** may discharge the treated water to a treated water storage tank of another wastewater filtration device. Alternatively, the treated water storage tank **150** may discharge the treated water or discharge it to another separate treatment device. Meanwhile, the treated water storage tank **150** receives backwash water from the outside. Here, the incoming backwash water may be treated water filtered by another wastewater filtration device.

(44) The strainer block **210** spatially separates the reaction tank **130** and the treated water storage tank **150**.

(45) In the strainer block **210**, nozzles **220** may be disposed at preset intervals. Similarly, fluids such as air or liquid pass through, but the filter media **138** does not pass through fine-sized holes, which are also formed in the nozzles **220**. Accordingly, the nozzles **220** introduce the treated water (oxygen) into the treated water storage tank and spray the backwash water into the reaction tank **130**. In particular, the nozzles **220** allow the backwash water to be sprayed at a speed greater than or equal to a preset reference value so that solids or organics growing or adhering to the filter media **134** and **138** can be smoothly washed.

(46) The strainer block **210** is implemented with a material having a hydrophilic surface, such as concrete. The filter media **138** have an adhesive force by the microorganisms and mucus that have grown on the surface of the filter media until they are washed by backwash water. Accordingly, the filter media **138** may float due to the wastewater inflow and may be attached to the strainer block **210**. However, when the filter media **138** have attached to the strainer block **210**, it causes problems such as clogging. Thus, the attachment of the filter material **138** to the strainer block **210** should be prevented. When the nozzles **220** are densely arranged in the strainer block **210**, this problem can be prevented, but in consideration of the structure or durability of the strainer block **210**, the nozzles **220** cannot be arranged at a narrow interval less than a predetermined interval within the strainer block **210**. Accordingly, there is a risk that the filter media **138** may be adhered to the gap between nozzles **220**. To prevent this, the strainer block **210** includes the concavo-convex portion **230** in the space between the nozzles **220**. The concavo-convex portion **230** is described later with reference to FIG. **10** and FIG. **11**.

(47) The controller (not shown) controls the inflow of wastewater into the inflow water box **110**, the inflow of backwash water into the treated water storage tank **150**, and the inflow of oxygen into the diffuser **140**.

(48) The controller (not shown) controls the discharge valve **126** and the inflow valve **129** to control the inflow of wastewater into the inflow water box **110** or the discharge of backwash water.

(49) The controller (not shown) controls the inflow supply of the backwash water into the treated water storage tank **150** and the injection of the backwash water. Wastewater is introduced into the reaction tank **130** by solids or organics that grow or attach on the filter media **134** and **138** to cause a head loss. Accordingly, the controller (not shown) measures the inflow pressure of wastewater with a pressure gauge (not shown) disposed in the reaction tank **130** to determine whether it reaches to a preset reference value. When the inflow pressure of the wastewater has reached to a preset reference value, it means that the number of solids or organics grown or attached to the filter media **134** and **138** has increased excessively, so it is the time when backwashing is necessary. Accordingly, the controller (not shown) controls to close the inflow valve **129** to block the inflow of wastewater and open the discharge valve **126** to introduce and discharge backwash water (pre-treated treatment water or treatment water from other wastewater filtration device) and controls the nozzles **220** to spray the backwash water.

(50) The controller (not shown) opens the oxygen supply valve **145a** and closes the washing air supply valve **145b** so that the diffuser **140a** supplies oxygen to the filter media **138** in the process of filtering according to the inflow of wastewater. On the other hand, the controller (not shown) opens the washing air supply valve **145b** and closes the oxygen supply valve **145a** so that the diffuser **140b** supplies the washing air to the reaction tank **130** in the process of backwashing the

filter media **134** and **138**.

(51) FIG. **4** is a schematic view illustrating a state in which wastewater are introduced into the wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(52) The wastewater introduced into the inflow water box **110** are distributed vertically upward, where the filter media **134** and **138** are located, by the distribution channel **120**. Accordingly, the filter media **134** and **138** are raised by the buoyancy force, and the filter media **138** receiving a relatively greater buoyancy, is arranged in a relatively upper layer, and the filter media **134** is relatively arranged in a lower layer. Relatively large solids in wastewater are filtered through the filter medium **134**, and relatively small solids and organics in the wastewater are removed by microorganisms growing on the surface of the filter media **138** through the filter media **138**. The treated water from which the contaminants are filtered passes through the strainer block **210** and the nozzle **220** and flows into the treated water storage tank **150**. The introduced treated water storage tank **150** is used as backwash water for itself or other devices or discharged to the outside.

(53) FIG. **5** is a schematic view illustrating a state in which backwash water is introduced into the wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(54) Meanwhile, backwashing is performed when the number of solids or organics growing or adhering to the filter media **134** and **138** increases, and the inflow pressure of the wastewater drops to a preset reference value. Backwash water is sprayed from the treated water storage tank **150** through the nozzle **220** to the reaction tank **130**. At this time, the washing air may be discharged from the diffuser **140b** therewith. For smooth backwashing of the filter media, backwash water may be sprayed at a rate of 60 m/hr to 120 m/hr, and washing air may be supplied at a rate of 10 m/hr to 40 m/hr. Solids or organics growing or attaching on the filter media **134** and **138** are detached by the supplied backwash water and washing air, and introduced into the distribution channel **120** with backwashing water. The introduced backwash water is discharged to the outside through the discharge valve **126**. In this case, the solids detached from the filter media **134** may have a density heavier than water and a significantly smaller size. Accordingly, the solids do not float in the backwash water, so they can stay in the detached position without moving with the backwash water. In order to prevent these solids from remaining in the filter media, the process of cleaning the filter media using backwash water and washing air may be repeated a plurality of times.

(55) FIG. **6** is a graph illustrating the solids removal rate of the wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention. FIG. **7** is a graph illustrating the TBOD removal rate of the wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention. FIG. **8** is a graph illustrating the SBOD removal rate of the wastewater filtration device according to an embodiment of the present invention. The experimental environment is as follows.

(56) The reaction tank **130** has a diameter of 1.2 meters, the filter media **134** are disposed at a depth of 1.0 meter, and the filter media **138** are disposed at a depth of 2.0 meters. Also, the height of the device was 5.5 meters. The wastewater was introduced into the device **100** and the residence time was 15 to 30 minutes. The washing air was supplied at 5.0 scfm, and the oxygen was supplied at a DO concentration of 5.0 to 8.0 mg/L.

(57) Referring to FIG. **6**, it was confirmed that the wastewater filtration device **100** removed 84% or more of the solids from influent wastewater.

(58) Referring to FIG. **7**, it was confirmed that the wastewater filtration device **100** reduced the BOD from influent wastewater by 810% or more. Further, it was confirmed that the maximum BOD removal rate of the wastewater filtration device **100** was 55.7 kgBOD/m³.Math.d, which is about 10 times higher than the BOD removal rate of 5.5 kgBOD/m³.Math.d, which is shown in the conventional filtration device. It was confirmed that the wastewater filtration device **100** might efficiently remove organics in a short time.

(59) Referring to FIG. **8**, it was confirmed that the wastewater filtration device **100** stably removes dissolved organic matters biologically about more than 74%.

(60) FIG. **9** is a flowchart illustrating a filtration method of the wastewater filtration device

according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(61) The distribution channel **120** distributes the influent wastewater upward (S910).

(62) The filter media **134** filter the solids from the wastewater upward (S920) The filter media **138** remove fine solids and organics of wastewater from which the solids are filtered (S930).

(63) The treated water storage tank **150** stores or discharges the treated water in which each component is filtered (S940).

(64) The treated water storage tank **150** sprays the backwash water downward (S950).

(65) The distribution channel **120** discharges the backwash water passed through the filter media **134** and **138** to the outside (S960).

(66) FIG. **10** is a cross-sectional view and a bottom view illustrating a strainer block and a nozzle according to an embodiment of the present invention. FIG. **11** is a cross-sectional view illustrating a strainer block according to various embodiments of the present invention.

(67) Referring to FIG. **10**, the concavo-convex portion **230** is a portion protruding from the strainer block **210** between the nozzles **220**. The concave-convex portion **230** is formed in the blind spot section where the backwash water cannot touch due to the spraying angle of the backwash water of the nozzle **220** and physically prevents the filter media **138** from attaching to the strainer block **210**. The concave-convex portion **230** protrudes to a position where the backwash water may be sprayed onto the surface of the concave-convex portion **230** according to the spraying angle of the backwash water of the nozzles **220**, so that the filter media **138** may be washed by the sprayed wash water although it is attached to the surface of the concave-convex portion **230**. Furthermore, unlike the strainer block **210**, the concave-convex portion **230** may be implemented with a material (the degree of adhesion of the filter media is relatively low compared to that of the strainer block) that is not easy for the filter media **138** to adhere thereto. As the concavo-convex portion **230** is implemented with the above-described material, it is possible to physically prevent the filter media **138** from attaching to the strainer block **210** as well as adhering to the concave-convex portion **230**.

(68) Since the concavo-convex portion **230** has a shape protruding from the strainer block **210**, it does not have a structure that spatially surrounds the nozzles **220**. Accordingly, although the concavo-convex portion **230** is formed in the strainer block **210**, a passage through which backwash water can move may be formed between the nozzles **220** or between the concavo-convex portions **230**. The adhesion of the filter media **138** is minimized by the concavo-convex portion and may be further minimized by backwash water moving between the nozzles **220** or between the concave-convex portions **230**.

(69) Furthermore, the concavo-convex portion **230** may further include protrusions **235** on the surface. As the protrusions **235** are formed on the surface of the concave-convex portion **230**, the probability that the filter media **138** adhere to the concave-convex portion **230** is significantly reduced. In particular, the protrusions **235** are formed on the surface of the concavo-convex portion **230** at intervals smaller than the diameter of the filter media **138**, thereby more effectively preventing the filter media **138** from adhering to the concave-convex portion **230**. In particular, since the size of the filter media **138** is larger than the distance between the formed protrusions **235**, the filter media **138** have not adhered between the protrusions **235**, and adhesion to the concavo-convex portion **230** is prevented by the protrusions **235**. For example, when the filter media have adhered between the protrusions, the protrusions may interfere with the path of backwash water, thereby reducing the backwashing efficiency of the filter media. The gap between the projections **235** is formed to be narrower than the size of the filter media **138**, thereby addressing the above-described issue.

(70) FIG. **10** illustrates that both the concave-convex portions **230** and the protrusions **235** are formed in a round (semi-circle) shape, but the present invention is not limited thereto. As shown in FIG. **11B**, FIG. **11C**, and FIG. **11D**, the concave-convex portions **230** may protrude in a triangular shape, and the protrusions **235** may protrude in a triangular shape regardless of the shape of the concave-convex portions **230**.

(71) FIG. 12 is a plan view illustrating the diffuser according to the first embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 13 is a plan view illustrating a diffuser according to a second embodiment of the present invention.

(72) Referring to FIG. 12, the diffuser **140**, according to the first embodiment of the present invention, includes the first main pipes **1210** and **1215**, branch pipes **1220** and **1225**, and a second main pipe **1230**.

(73) The diffuser **140** is disposed at the outside of the reaction tank **130** or a position separated by a preset distance from the outside of the reaction tank **130** into the reaction tank **130**. The diffuser **140** is disposed at the corresponding position and supplies air for the growth of microorganisms or washing into the reaction tank **130**.

(74) An outlet for supplying air into the reaction tank **130** is formed in the diffuser. At this time, when the supply of air is stopped, wastewater or backwash water (hereinafter, referred to as "water") in the reaction tank **130** is introduced to the outlet temporarily or continuously. The water introduced into the diffuser prevents the air from being released to the outlet again later, thereby preventing sufficient air for microbial growth or washing into the reaction tank **130** and increasing the pressure in the diffuser and the pressure of the incoming air.

(75) In order to address these issues, the diffuser **140** comprises the first main pipes **1210** and **1215** into which air is supplied to the reaction tank **130** or air for facilitating the discharge of water introduced into the diffuser **140** is injected, a second main pipe **1230** for discharging the air introduced into the first main pipes and the water introduced into the diffuser to the outside, and branch pipes **1220** and **1225** connecting the first main pipe and the second main pipe.

(76) The first main pipes **1210** and **1215** introduce air from outside for supplying to the reaction tank **130** or discharging the water introduced into the diffuser **140**. As the size of the reaction tank **130** increases, the size of the diffuser **140** also increases accordingly. As the size of the diffuser **140** increases, the amount of water introduced into the diffuser **140** also increases. Accordingly, when the amount and delivery speed of air introduced into the first main pipes **1210** and **1215** are improved, the discharge speed and efficiency of water passing through the first main pipes **1210** and **1215** may be improved. Accordingly, the first main pipes **1210** and **1215** are branched in a plurality of pipes, and the air is supplied to each of the first main pipes **1210** and **1215**, respectively. The first main pipes **1210** and **1215** may be branched in an appropriate number according to the area of the diffuser **140**, and the amount of air and the delivery speed are improved according to the number of branches.

(77) The branch pipes **1220** and **1225** connect the first main pipes **1210** and **1215**, respectively, and the second main pipe **1230**. Each of the branch pipes **1220** and **1225** may connect each of the first main pipes **1210** and **1215**, and the second main pipe **1230** as a single pipe, but a plurality of branch pipes at preset intervals may connect both pipes, respectively. In this way, since a plurality of branch pipes **1220** and **1225** connect both pipes at a predetermined interval, the diffuser **140** may have a stable structure, thereby improving water and air discharge efficiency. Since the plurality of branch pipes connect both the main pipes **1210**, **1215**, and **1230**, it may have structural stability. Further, the plurality of branch pipes are arranged at regular intervals, so the air introduced into the first main pipes **1210** and **1215** and the water discharged by the introduced air pressure may be dispersed and introduced into the second main pipe **1230**. If only one branch pipe connects the two main pipes, a considerable amount of pressure may be applied to the branch pipe or the connecting part of the main pipe to the branch pipe, depending on the amount of water and air introduced. To prevent this issue, a plurality of branch pipes **1220** and **1225** are installed at regular intervals, so water and air may be dispersed into each branch pipe and introduced into the second main pipe.

(78) The second main pipe **1230** is disposed between the first main pipes **1210** and **1215**, and discharges water and air passed through the branch pipe to the outside.

(79) The second main pipe **1230** is disposed between the first main pipes **1210** and **1215**. As described above, the first main pipes **1210** and **1215** are arranged to be branched into a plurality.

The second main pipe **1230** is disposed between the branched first main pipes. As described above, the branch pipes **1220** and **1225** connect the first and second main pipes, and the lengths of the branch pipes **1220** and **1225** vary according to the arrangement of the first and second main pipes. As the length of the branch pipes **1220** and **1225** increases, the stability of the diffuser **140** decreases, and difficulties exist in manufacturing or connection (welding, etc.) with the main pipes. Accordingly, the second main pipe **1230** is disposed between the first main pipes **1210** and **1215** to minimize the length of the branch pipe.

(80) The second main pipe **1230** discharges water and air introduced from each branch pipe to the outside. Unlike the first main pipe, only one second main pipe **1230** is installed. Since water and air flowing into the first main pipes, **1210** and **1215** are distributed and delivered by the plurality of branch pipes **1220** and **1225**, the water introduced into the diffuser **140** may be discharged with a single main pipe **1230**.

(81) With this structure, the diffuser **140** may quickly discharge the water introduced therein.

(82) FIG. **12** shows that the first main pipes are branched into two first main pipes **1210** and **1215** pipes, but the present invention is not limited thereto. As shown in FIG. **13**, the first main pipes may be branched into four first main pipes **1310**, **1315**, **1320**, and **1325** and may be branched into four or more main pipes. In this case, although the first main pipes are branched into several pipes, the second main pipe **1230** may be disposed in the middle of the first main pipes in order to minimize the length of the branch pipe.

(83) FIG. **14** is a cross-sectional view illustrating a main or branch pipe according to an embodiment of the present invention. FIG. **15** is a view illustrating a drag force applied to a conventional diffuser and a diffuser according to an embodiment of the present invention. FIG. **16** is a view illustrating the size of a conventional diffuser and a diffuser according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(84) Referring to FIG. **15**, the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230**, according to an embodiment of the present invention, include an outlet **1410**, a reinforcing support **1420**, and a support **1430**.

(85) The main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** introduce air for microbial growth, backwashing, or discharge of water from the outside. The main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** have a hollow therein so that air flows into the inside to flow in one direction according to the applied pressure.

(86) At this time, drag force is applied to the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** by the wastewater, backwash water, or filter media that ascends or descends. The drag force acting on the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** satisfies the following formula.

$$(87) F_d = \frac{C_d A_p}{2} \rho_w v_p^2$$

(88) Here, F.sub.d is the drag force, C.sub.d is the drag coefficient, A.sub.p is the area of action, ρ.sub.w is the density of the fluid, and v.sub.p is the velocity of the fluid. Typically, the main or branch pipe has a circular cross-sectional area. The main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** have an elliptical, rather than circular, cross-sectional area to reduce the applied drag. The main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** have a relatively reduced cross-sectional area in order to minimize the drag force applying to them from the fluid or the floating media. The cross-sectional area of the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** has an elliptical shape, and the major axis is arranged in the vertical direction (the direction in which the fluid or floating media ascends and descends), so that the working area of the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** may be significantly smaller. Compared with a conventional circular cross-sectional area, its working area can be reduced by half or more.

(89) Referring to FIG. **15**, a significant drag is applied to the conventional main or branch pipe **1510**, while a half or more reduced drag is applied to the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** due to a reduction in the working area.

(90) Referring back to FIG. **14**, the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** have a relatively excellent secondary moment because they have the aforementioned cross-sectional area. Moment refers to the action of a force that tries to rotate an object, and its magnitude is calculated as the product of

the force (F) and the distance from the axis of rotation to the line of action of the force (r). The secondary moment is proportional to the flexural strength of the pipe. Thus, the higher the secondary moment, the better the flexural strength of the pipe. The conventional piping and the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** may have the following secondary moment values depending on the shape of the cross-sectional area.

(91) The conventional pipe **1510** having a circular-cross section, shown in FIG. **16A**, has the following secondary moment values.

(92)
$$\frac{(D^4 - d^4)}{32D}$$

(93) On the other hand, the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** having an elliptical cross-section, shown in FIG. **16B**, have the following secondary moment values.

(94)
$$\frac{(a^2 b - c^3 d)}{4a}$$

(95) As can be seen from the above-described secondary moment value, it is confirmed that the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** have a relatively large secondary moment value compared to the conventional pipe **1510**. For example, when a 32 mm (**10S**) pipe of KS standard is applied, the secondary moment of the conventional pipe (circular cross-section) is 7.0 cm⁴, while the secondary moment of the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** is 11.9 cm⁴. This is about 1.7 times the improved value compared to that of the conventional pipe.

(96) Referring back to FIG. **14**, as the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** have an elliptical cross-sectional area, it is possible to lower the drag force received from the outside while having high bending strength (secondary moment). Accordingly, the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** may prevent deformation due to buoyancy caused by the ascending and descending fluid or frictional force with the descending fluid or the ascending and descending filter media.

(97) The reinforcing support **1420** surrounds the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230**, and the support **1430** supports the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** under the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230**, respectively. The reinforcing support **1420** or support **1430** prevents the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** disposed by buoyancy caused by the ascending and descending fluid or frictional force with the descending fluid or the ascending and descending filter media from being deviated from their original positions. As described above, since the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** have a reduced area, the size of the-to-be-installed reinforcing support **1420** may be reduced. Accordingly, the amount of the-to-be-installed reinforcing support **1420** in the entire diffuser **140** may be significantly reduced. The reinforcing support **1420** and the support **1430** may be set as one set, and the respective sets may be disposed at a preset interval. When the reinforcing support **1420** and the support **1430** are closely arranged, the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230** may be stably supported. However, the amount of to-be-installed set increases, and the drag force acting on the set, main, or branch pipe increases. Accordingly, the reinforcing support **1420** and the support **1430**, respectively, may be disposed at a regular interval to support the main or branch pipes **1210** to **1230**.

(98) FIG. **9** shows that each process is sequentially executed. However, this is merely illustrative of the technical concept of an embodiment of the present invention. In other words, a person of ordinary skill in the art to which an embodiment of the present invention pertains may apply various modifications and variations, such as executing a change in the order described in each drawing or executing one or more processes among processes in parallel without departing from the essential characteristics of an embodiment of the present invention. Accordingly, FIG. **9** is not limited to chronological order.

(99) Meanwhile, the processes shown in FIG. **9** can be implemented as computer-readable codes on a computer-readable recording medium. The computer-readable recording medium includes all kinds of recording devices in which data readable by a computer system is stored. That is, the computer-readable recording medium includes a magnetic storage medium (e.g., a ROM, a floppy disk, a hard disk, etc.) and an optical readable medium (e.g., a CD-ROM, a DVD, etc.). Further, the

computer-readable recording medium is distributed in a network-connected computer system so that the computer-readable code can be stored and executed in a distributed manner.

(100) The above description is merely illustrative of the technical idea of the present embodiment, and a person skilled in the art to which the present embodiment belongs may make various modifications and variations without departing from the essential characteristics of the present embodiment. Accordingly, the present embodiments are intended to explain rather than limit the technical spirit of the present embodiment, and the scope of the technical spirit of the present embodiment is not limited by these embodiments. The protection scope of the present embodiment should be interpreted by the following claims, and all technical ideas within the equivalent range should be interpreted as being included in the scope of the present embodiment.

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

(101) This patent application claims priority in accordance with 35 U.S.C. § 119(a) of the U.S. Patent Act with respect to KR Patent Application Nos. 10-2020-0066398, 10-2020-0066423, and 10-2020-0066444, each filed in Korea on Jun. 2, 2020, all contents of which are incorporated herein by reference. Further, if this patent application claims priority for countries other than the United States for the same reason as above, all contents thereof are incorporated into this patent application by reference.

Claims

1. A filtration device for treating wastewater, the device comprising: a distribution channel for distributing a wastewater vertically upward or discharging backwash water, received vertically downward, to outside of the filtration device; a floating filter media for raising due to having a lower specific gravity than water when the wastewater is distributed vertically upward from the distribution channel to filter solids and organics in the wastewater and descending when the backwash water flows in vertically downward to remove attached solids and organics; and a treated water storage tank for receiving the treated water from which solids and organics are removed through the filter media and discharging it to the outside of the filtration device or discharging the backwash water flowing in from the outside of the filtration device to the filter media by spraying, wherein the filter media comprises a first filter media and a second filter media having different sizes and has a lower specific gravity than water, and wherein a layer of the first filter media with a first diameter is disposed below a layer of the second filter media with a second diameter greater than the first diameter in a reaction tank, and the first filter media removes solids, and the second filter media removes dissolve organics in the wastewater using aerobic microorganisms grown on a surface of the second filter media.
 2. The filtration device of claim 1, further comprising a nozzle for being disposed at one end of the treated water storage tank, having a plurality of outlets smaller than the filter media, and receiving or discharging wastewater or backwash water.
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